Experiment 2

Ex. No.: 2

Live Forensics Case Investigation Using Autopsy

Aim

To learn the Autopsy case workflow for adding an authorised evidence source and reviewing the forensic artefacts produced by ingest modules.

Tools required

1. Autopsy digital forensics platform.
2. A Windows or Linux workstation with sufficient case storage.
3. An authorised disk image, logical files, or other supported data source.
4. Case number, evidence identifier, examiner details, and a report directory.

Idea/Theory

1. Autopsy organises evidence under a case and records data-source processing in a local case database.
2. Ingest modules extract and categorise artefacts such as accounts, recent documents, EXIF metadata, installed programs, bookmarks, cookies, downloads, web history, searches, and email addresses.
3. The examiner should work on an acquired evidence source, preserve its hashes, and document the selected modules and time settings.
4. Autopsy findings are leads that must be validated against the source artefact before they are reported as conclusions.

Experiment 2 — continued

Procedure/Steps

1. Install Autopsy and start it. Select **New Case**.
2. Enter the case name and choose a base directory in which the case database and report material will be stored.
3. Enter the case number and examiner details, then finish the case-creation wizard.
4. Select **Add Data Source** and choose the correct source type for the authorised evidence.
5. Browse to the evidence path and confirm the source details. Record or verify the acquisition hash when one is available.
6. Configure the required ingest modules. The manual selects all modules to obtain a broad artefact inventory.
7. Start ingest and allow Autopsy to add the processed source to its local case database.

Experiment 2 — continued

Procedure/Steps (continued)

1. After processing completes, review the result tree and generated forensic report.
2. Open **Devices Attached** to review devices associated with the system.
3. Review **EXIF Metadata**, **Installed Programs**, and **Operating System Information**.
4. Review operating-system user accounts and recent documents.
5. Inspect web bookmarks, cookies, downloads, history, searches, and extracted email addresses.
6. Validate important entries against the original artefact and export only authorised findings with case notes.

Observation/Output

Screenshots to be attached from the lab run (tool: Autopsy)

Result

To be completed after the lab run.